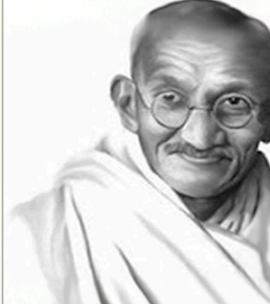


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

**Freedom Movement - Extremist
Phase(1905-1916)**



Freedom Movement - Extremist Phase (1905 - 1916)

Rise of Extremism in Indian Nationalism

The early phase of the Indian National Congress (INC) was dominated by the **moderates**, who believed in **constitutional methods and petitions** to bring reforms. However, dissatisfaction with the British rule grew among the younger leaders, leading to the **rise of extremists or Neo-nationalists**. These leaders advocated for confrontation with British rule.

Key Factors Leading to Extremism:

- **Disillusionment with Moderates:** Their policies could have been more effective.
- **Exposition of British Rule:** Early nationalist leaders like Dadabhai Naoroji exposed the economic drain theory.
- **Formation of Extremist Group:** Lokamanya Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, Aurobindo Ghose, and Lala Lajpat Rai became the key figures.
- **The slogan of Swaraj:** Tilak's famous slogan, "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it," symbolized the aspirations for complete freedom.

Major Political Factors for Extremism:

The political environment also played a critical role in the rise of extremism.

Factor	Details
Civil Services Examinations	Indian students were denied permission to appear for Civil Services Examinations.
Indian Council Act (1892)	Failed to provide an elective element in governance.
Famine in Maharashtra (1896)	Mismanagement during the famine led to anger against British rule.
Tariff and Cotton Duties Act (1894 & 1896)	Imposition of duties that favored British industries over Indian ones.
Partition of	Divisive policies like partition further fueled nationalism.

Bengal (1905)	
Defeat of Russia (1904-05)	Japan's victory over Russia inspired Indian revolutionaries.
Freedom of Press Curbed (1904)	The introduction of press restrictions worsened the relationship with British rule.

Key Extremist Leaders

1. Bal Gangadhar Tilak (Father of Indian Unrest)

- Slogan: "Swaraj is my birthright, and I shall have it."
- He was regarded as **Lokmanya Tilak**.
- **Methods:** Advocated **Swadeshi**, boycott of British goods, and self-rule.
- He joined the **Indian National Congress** in 1890.
- **Contributions:**
 - He promoted mass mobilization and direct action against British rule.
 - Organized festivals like **Ganpati Utsav** and **Chhatrapati Shivaji festival** to promote nationalism.
 - He was instrumental in the **Home Rule League movement (1916)**.
 - Tilak started his Home Rule League in **Maharashtra, Central Provinces, and Karnataka and Berar region**.
 - He faced multiple arrests on **charges of sedition**, with his longest imprisonment spanning from **1908 to 1914**. During this time, he authored the renowned book "**Gita Rahasya**" (The Secret of the Bhagavad Gita).
 - He actively advocated for the elimination of social evils such as **untouchability** and **child marriage** while promoting **women's education**.
 - In 1916, he finalized the **Lucknow Pact** with **Mohammed Ali Jinnah**, fostering **Hindu-Muslim unity** in the fight for national independence.



2. Bipin Chandra Pal (Father of Revolutionary Thought)

- **Methods:** Promoted **Swadeshi**, national education, and passive resistance.
- He, along with **Lala Lajpat Rai** and **Bal Gangadhar Tilak**, formed the trio of radical nationalist leaders famously known as "**Lal-Bal-Pal**."

- **Contributions:**

- Bipin Chandra Pal joined the **Indian National Congress in 1886**.
- Leading figure in the **Swadeshi Movement (1905)**.
- Emphasized the importance of mass political education and boycott.
- Worked to inspire radical nationalist ideology among the masses.
- Bipin Chandra Pal authored several notable books, including **Nationality and Empire, Indian Nationalism, The Basis of Social Reform, Swaraj and the Present Situation, The Soul of India, and The New Spirit and Studies in Hinduism**.
- He also edited prominent national journals such as **The Independent and The Democrat**.

3. Lala Lajpat Rai (Punjab Kesari)

- **Methods:** Advocated militant nationalism, Swadeshi, and self-reliance.

- **Contributions:**

- Led protests against the **Partition of Bengal (1905)**.
- Established national educational institutions like **Dayanand Anglo-Vedic (DAV) Schools**.
- Played a crucial role in boycotting British goods.
- He spent a year in exile and authored "**The History of the Indian National Movement**", a book detailing the struggle for Indian independence and the challenges faced by the Indian people.
- In **October 1917**, he founded the **Indian Home Rule League of America** in New York.
- He played a key role in founding a bank that eventually became known as the **Punjab National Bank**.
- In Punjab, he led intense protests against the British, condemning their brutal actions at **Jallianwala Bagh** and their enforcement of the **Rowlatt Act**.

4. Aurobindo Ghose

- **Methods:** Focused on **revolutionary violence** and armed resistance.

- **Contributions:**

- A key leader in shaping the revolutionary movement against British rule.
- Advocated for complete independence through direct action.
- Influenced the formation of **secret societies** aimed at overthrowing British rule.
- He launched the patriotic journal **Bande Mataram** to promote radical approaches and revolutionary strategies over submissive methods.

- Aurobindo, a revolutionary and militant nationalist, was arrested and imprisoned in connection with the **Alipore Bomb Case (1906–1910)**.
- In **1926**, he established a community of spiritual seekers that later became known as the **Sri Aurobindo Ashram**.
- He contributed significantly to literature with works such as the English newspaper **Bande Mataram (1905)**, and notable writings including **Bases of Yoga, Bhagavad Gita and Its Message, The Future Evolution of Man, Rebirth and Karma, Savitri: A Legend and a Symbol, and Hour of God**.

Extremist Ideologies & Methods

- The extremists differed from the moderates in their goals and methods. The demand for **Swaraj (self-rule)** by extremists was focused on **complete independence**, unlike the moderates, who sought colonial self-government within the Empire.

Methods of Extremism:

- **Mass Mobilization:** Focused on mass action and political work among the public.
- **Swadeshi & Boycott:** Advocated boycotting British goods and promoting Indian products (Swadeshi).
- **Self-Reliance:** Sought to build self-confidence among the people to resist British rule.

Moderates vs. Extremists

- Early Congress leaders were liberal and moderate, preferring democratic and constitutional methods. Hence, they were termed Moderates.
- The Extremists, or neo-nationalists, advocated for radical measures to oppose British rule.
- In 1907, the Congress split into two factions due to ideological differences—**Moderates** and **Extremists**.
- **Public Support:** The Moderates mainly drew support from the educated middle class, while the Extremists had a broader base, attracting both the middle class and rural masses, especially from Maharashtra and Bengal.
- **Influence on Future Movements:** The Moderates influenced future leaders like Mahatma Gandhi, who initially adopted their constitutional methods, whereas the Extremists inspired revolutionary activities and militant nationalism, contributing to the rise of groups like the Ghadar Party and Anushilan Samiti.

Aspect	Moderates	Extremists
Ideological Approach	Believed in gradual reform and constitutional methods.	Advocated for immediate and radical changes.

Leadership	Leaders like Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Dadabhai Naoroji, and W.C. Bonnerjee.	Leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Lala Lajpat Rai, and Bipin Chandra Pal.
Method of Protest	Focused on prayers, petitions, and peaceful protests.	Emphasized direct action, boycotts, and mass mobilization.
Attitude towards British	Sought to work within the existing framework, believing that the British would listen to reason.	Distrusted British intentions and called for confrontation.
Demands	Demanded political representation and civil rights, like freedom of speech and press.	Called for self-rule and immediate independence.
Impact of Methods	Gained limited concessions from the British, including the Indian Council Act of 1892.	Sparked a larger public engagement and awareness about Indian nationalism.
Views on Society	Believed in gradual education and political awareness among Indians.	Focused on awakening the masses and instilling a sense of urgency.
Outcome of Split (1907)	Many moderates felt sidelined and struggled to adapt to more aggressive nationalist sentiments.	The extremists gained prominence, pushing the Congress towards more assertive demands.
Legacy	Laid the groundwork for future movements by emphasizing political dialogue and constitutionalism.	Energized the freedom struggle by introducing a more assertive and militant approach.

Major Movements and Incidents during the Extremist Period

Event/Movement	Details
Partition of Bengal (1905)	Lord Curzon divided Bengal into East Bengal (Muslim majority) and West Bengal (Hindu majority).
Anti-Partition Agitation (1905)	Massive protests including a hartal and the Raksha Bandhan ceremony symbolizing Hindu-Muslim unity.
Swadeshi Movement (1905)	Indians began boycotting British goods and promoting local industries.
Surat Split (1907)	Internal conflict within INC between moderates and extremists led to a split.
Foundation of Muslim League (1906)	Inspired by the Aligarh movement, the All-India Muslim League was established to represent Muslim interests.
Morley-Minto Reforms (1909)	Introduced separate electorates for Muslims, deepening communal divisions.
Gadar Movement (1913)	Anti-colonial movement initiated by Indian immigrants in the USA, primarily in San Francisco, under the banner of the Gadar Party.
Home Rule League (1916)	Significant chapter in India's freedom struggle, led by Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Annie Besant.

Partition of Bengal (1905)

- The Partition of Bengal in 1905 stands as a pivotal moment in Indian history, shaping the political and social landscape of the time.
- Background
 - At the time, Bengal was not only the most populous province of British India but also a thriving center of political and cultural awakening. However, the British government claimed that Bengal was too vast and unwieldy to govern effectively.
 - They cited administrative efficiency as the reason for the impending partition, setting the stage for significant unrest.
- The Partition
- On July 19, 1905, the British officially announced the partition, dividing Bengal into two parts:
 - East Bengal and Assam, were predominantly Muslim areas.
 - West Bengal, which had a majority Hindu population.

- This division was strategic; the British hoped to create a wedge between **Hindus** and **Muslims**, believing that fostering communal discord would weaken the growing nationalist movement.
- **Reactions to the Partition**
 - The announcement of the partition ignited immediate backlash across India.
 - Nationalist leaders from the **Indian National Congress** and other organizations voiced strong opposition, sparking widespread protests.
 - This resistance gave rise to the Swadeshi Movement, which encouraged Indians to boycott British goods and support indigenous industries.
- Moreover, the partition catalyzed cultural revival, inspiring a sense of nationalism that transcended religious boundaries. Calls for unity among Indians grew louder as people rallied against what they saw as a divisive British strategy.
- **Consequences**
 - The agitation against the partition led to a surge in political mobilization among the Indian populace.
 - Nationalistic sentiments reached new heights, as many Indians became increasingly aware of their political rights and the need to resist colonial rule.
 - This period also saw the formation of various nationalist organizations, such as the Anushilan Samiti, which actively worked to oppose British authority.
 - Ultimately, the relentless pressure from Indian activists forced the British government to reverse the partition on December 12, 1911, reuniting Bengal.
- **Long-term Impact**
 - While the partition was rescinded, it left an indelible mark on Indian society.
 - It sowed seeds of communal tension that would have far-reaching implications, particularly during the Indian independence movement and the subsequent partition of India in 1947.
 - In a broader sense, the events surrounding the partition highlighted the growing importance of mass mobilization in the Indian freedom struggle.
 - It underscored how regional identities and collective action could challenge colonial rule, marking a significant turning point in the fight for independence.

Anti-Partition Agitation (1905)

Nature of Protests:

- Included hartals (strikes) and demonstrations.
- The **Raksha Bandhan ceremony** was symbolically used to promote unity between Hindus and Muslims, showcasing a collective opposition to the partition.

Key Actions:

- Mass mobilization across Bengal, led by prominent leaders like **Bipin Chandra Pal**, **Lala Lajpat Rai**, and **Aurobindo Ghose**.

- Formation of committees and organizations to spread awareness about the dangers of partition.

Impact:

- Raised national consciousness and became a precursor to the Swadeshi Movement.
- Demonstrated the power of mass protests against British policies.

Swadeshi Movement:

The Swadeshi Movement was a powerful grassroots response to the Partition of Bengal and had several important aspects:

- **Boycott of Foreign Goods:** The movement called for the boycott of British products, promoting Indian-made goods as a way to challenge colonial economic dominance. This led to a surge in local industries and handicrafts.
- **Cultural Revival:** The movement inspired a renewed interest in Indian culture, heritage, and nationalism. Events like the Swadeshi Mela (fairs) celebrated indigenous crafts and products.
- **Unity Across Communities:** The Swadeshi Movement transcended regional and communal lines, uniting people from diverse backgrounds in a common cause, fostering a sense of solidarity and national pride.

Foundation of Muslim League (1906):

The Muslim League was founded in 1906 in Dhaka to safeguard the political rights of Muslims in British India.

- The League was inspired by the **Aligarh movement**, led by **Sir Syed Ahmad Khan**, which focused on the educational and social **upliftment** of **Muslims**.
- Muslim leaders felt the need for a separate political platform, as they believed the **Indian National Congress (INC)** did not adequately represent Muslim interests.
- **Purpose:** The primary objective was to protect Muslim political rights and ensure representation in legislative bodies.
- It aimed to counterbalance the growing influence of the INC, which was seen as dominated by Hindu interests.
- **Key Leaders:** Early leadership included figures like **Aga Khan**, **Nawab Salimullah**, and later **Mohammad Ali Jinnah**, who would become the most prominent leader of the League.
- **Impact:** The formation of the Muslim League laid the foundation for the two-nation theory, which argued that Muslims and Hindus were distinct nations.
- This ideology ultimately contributed to the demand for a separate Muslim state, leading to the creation of **Pakistan** in **1947**.

Surat Split (1907):

The Surat Split (1907) was a critical event in the Indian National Congress (INC) where internal divisions came to the forefront.

- **Background:** The INC was divided between the moderates, led by figures like Gopal Krishna Gokhale, who favored gradual reforms through constitutional methods, and the extremists, led by Bal Gangadhar Tilak, who advocated for direct action and Swaraj (self-rule).
- **Conflict:** Tensions rose over how to confront British rule. The moderates sought negotiation and dialogue, while the extremists pushed for immediate self-rule and mass agitation.
- **At the Surat session of the INC in 1907,** these differences culminated in open conflict, leading to a split.
- **Outcome:** The extremists broke away from the INC, forming a separate faction.
- This division weakened the nationalist movement, temporarily reducing the INC's influence and delaying unified efforts for independence. However, the split also laid the groundwork for future strategies by both factions.

Morley-Minto Reforms (1909)

The Morley-Minto Reforms (1909), also known as the Indian Councils Act of 1909, were introduced by John Morley, the British Secretary of State for India, and Lord Minto, the Viceroy of India.

These reforms aimed to provide limited political reform in India, addressing growing nationalist demands.

Key Features:

- The reforms increased the size of both the **Imperial Legislative Council** and the provincial councils, allowing more Indians to participate in governance.
- **Separate Electorates for Muslims:** The most significant feature was the introduction of separate electorates for Muslims.
- This allowed **Muslims** to elect their representatives to the councils, separate from the Hindu electorate.
- It was a concession to the **Muslim League**, which had demanded special political representation for Muslims.
- **Indian Representation:** While a few Indians were nominated to the councils, including **Satyendra Prasanna Sinha**, who became the first Indian to join the **Viceroy's Executive Council**, real power remained in British hands.

Consequences:

- **Communal Divisions:** The establishment of separate electorates for Muslims institutionalized the divide between Hindus and Muslims, fostering communal politics. This deepened religious divisions and set a precedent for future demands for communal representation.
- **Limited Reforms:** While the reforms introduced Indians to the legislative process, they offered no real control over the executive branch of the government. This left many Indian nationalists dissatisfied, as their demands for self-governance were not addressed.

- **Growth of Communal Representation:** Instead of reducing tensions, the reforms highlighted and exacerbated the differences between the two communities, paving the way for further communal demands and increasing calls for autonomy from different sections of Indian society.

Gadar Movement (1913):

The Gadar Movement (1913) was an **anti-colonial movement** initiated by Indian immigrants in the USA, primarily in **San Francisco**, under the banner of the **Gadar Party**.

- It was started by a group of **Punjabi Sikhs, Hindus, and Muslims**, many of whom were workers and students.
- Key leaders included **Lala Har Dayal, Sohan Singh Bhakna, and Rashbehari Bose**. The word "**Gadar**" means revolt, symbolizing their commitment to overthrowing British rule through armed rebellion.
- The **primary goal** was to overthrow British rule in India through armed insurrection.
- They aimed to inspire a mass uprising in India by rallying expatriates and Indians serving in the British military.
- The Gadar Party saw **World War I** as an opportunity to launch a rebellion, hoping the British preoccupation with the war would create favorable conditions.
- In **1915**, Gadar leaders planned a military uprising in India by encouraging soldiers in the British **Indian Army** to **mutiny**.
- Despite meticulous planning, the British intelligence discovered the plot, leading to preemptive arrests and the suppression of the movement.
- The revolt failed, and many Gadar leaders were either executed or imprisoned.

However, the Gadar Movement left a legacy of martyrdom and inspired future revolutionary activities in India's struggle for independence.

Home Rule League (1916):

- The **Home Rule League Movement (1916)** was a significant chapter in India's freedom struggle, led by **Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Annie Besant**.
- The movement aimed to achieve self-government within the British Empire, similar to the autonomy sought by Ireland.

Background:

- After the **Surat Split of 1907**, where the Indian National Congress was divided between moderates and extremists, the national movement lost momentum.
- The outbreak of **World War I in 1914** had further diverted attention, and the British government in India, facing mounting pressures from the war, was unwilling to consider constitutional reforms.

Leaders:

- **Bal Gangadhar Tilak:** After his return from imprisonment in Mandalay (1908–1914), Tilak sought to mobilize people towards self-rule.

- In 1916, he established the Home Rule League in Maharashtra, focusing on Western India.
- **Annie Besant:** A prominent theosophist and social reformer, Besant was active in Madras (Chennai) and set up her branch of the Home Rule League, primarily covering southern India. Her work broadened the movement's base, attracting diverse sections of society, including women, students, and professionals.
- **Objectives:** The primary goal was to demand "Swaraj" (self-government) under British rule but without the extreme demand for complete independence.
- They advocated for:
 - Establishment of Home Rule (autonomous rule by Indians within the Empire).
 - Greater involvement of Indians in governance through legislative reforms.
 - Raising political consciousness among Indians across different regions.

Methods:

- **Public Meetings and Pamphlets:** The leaders organized large public meetings, distributed pamphlets, and built a network of local branches to spread their message.
- **Petitions and propaganda campaigns** highlighted the right of Indians to self-govern, drawing attention both in India and Britain.

Impact:

- The movement reinvigorated nationalist sentiment after the stagnation following the **Surat Split** and **Swadeshi Movement**.
- It prepared the ground for Gandhi's mass movements, who took up leadership of the national cause soon after.
- Though the Home Rule League did not achieve immediate self-governance, it played a key role in generating a new wave of political activism and fostering a sense of unity among Indians.
- Besant and Tilak's efforts led to the **Lucknow Pact (1916)**, where the Indian National Congress and Muslim League temporarily aligned, representing a significant moment in Hindu-Muslim cooperation.

Outcome:

- The British government responded with repressive measures, but in 1917, the Montagu Declaration promised gradual development towards self-governance.
- The movement lost momentum by 1918, but its legacy of decentralized political activism and the push for Home Rule directly influenced future strategies in the freedom struggle.